HamperQuote: a test of whether small custom-hamper sellers will pay for faster, safer quoting

Samriddhi Chandra ·That all checks out. The 283 figure is now consistent across the files, and the D7 row is in the decision log. The search came back clean:

*- `node_modules` **in the README:** this is only the instruction text.*

*- `api` **in** `quote-logic.js`**:** this is a variable name (`const api`), not a key or credential.*

*- `.env`, `key`, `password`, `token`**:** no matches.*

Four things left, all yours

*1. **Re-export the PDF.** The old PDF was made before the 283 edit.*

- Open `deliverables/business_recommendation.md` in VS Code and press Ctrl+Shift+V for the preview.

- Print it to PDF from the browser, or paste it into Word and save as PDF.

- Check it is 3 pages or fewer, then save it over the old PDF.

*2. **Fill in the evidence file.** Paste the original Codex messages into `evidence/ai_conversation_excerpt.md`:*

- Your first prompt and Codex's critique, including the ₹499/₹999 suggestion.

- Your pushback prompt and Codex's reply.

- Codex's note on the 260 vs 283 error.

- Delete my placeholder text at the top. If the excerpt is partial, say so in one line.

*3. **Replace** `[YOUR HOURS]` *in the README with your real time. Keep it consistent with what you say in the video.*

*4. **Record the video.** Use the script and show the final files. For the AI-judgment segment (4:00–4:35), tell the D6 story:*

- Codex suggested a ₹499/₹999 split test.

- You rejected it because the groups of 10 are too small and the ₹499 offer anchors sellers low.

- You replaced it with ₹999 for everyone, plus tracking of rejection reasons.

- You can add that Codex also caught the 260 vs 283 contact mismatch.

Then submit

*- **Folder:** Zip or upload the folder to Drive or GitHub, with no `node_modules`.*

*- **Recommendation:** Upload the PDF.*

*- **Video:** Upload the recording.*

*- **Links:** Open all three links in an incognito window to confirm they work.*

*- **Form:** Fill in your application email and the working-condition confirmation, then add the three links.*

Your deadline is 72 hours from the assignment email, so leave some buffer. Innovista Labs Founder's Office assignment · 18 Oct 2026 · Desk research only; no customers contacted. Sources: research/source_log.md (S1–S7).

A. Recommendation

Test a **₹999 one-time, 60-day "Festive Season Pass"** for small, home-based or Instagram-run hamper sellers who take custom orders over WhatsApp/DMs. The tool turns an inquiry (budget, occasion, quantity, items, personalisation, date) into a checked, itemised quote and a customer-ready summary. **Why now:** Diwali and wedding season concentrate inquiries, and Meta is actively pushing WhatsApp tools to Indian SMBs for the festive rush, with hampers as an example (S1). **Honest view:** this is a *worth-a-cheap-test* idea, not a proven one. In my scoring it narrowly beat a home-tutor fee tracker (3.43 vs 3.39; docs/decision_log.md), and every evidence score was low because I have no seller data.

B. Customer and problem

Customer: a solo seller (1–3 people) of custom hampers, doing roughly 10–100-hamper orders, selling via Instagram and WhatsApp, below the 50+ minimums large players set for customisation (S2). **Current workflow (inferred, B):** inquiry arrives in a DM or voice note → seller asks follow-ups → computes cost in head/notepad/spreadsheet → sends a typed quote → negotiates. **Costly friction (hypothesis, C):** missing details, quotes that ignore personalisation lead time or minimums, under-priced items, and slow replies during peak. **Today they use:** WhatsApp Business, spreadsheets, memory, or free quotation templates (S4).

C. Evidence and competition

Finding	Class	Source
Meta promotes WhatsApp catalogue and auto-reply tools to Indian SMBs; hampers named as an example	Verified (press report)	S1
A large seller handles customisation via human consultation, 50+ minimums, 5–7 day lead times	Verified (company page)	S2, S3
Free quotation maker exists for small businesses	Verified	S4
Small sellers lose time/money on quoting	**Assumption, no source**	—
Sellers will pay for a quote tool	**Unknown**	—

Competition: Vyapar free quotes (generic, no hamper rules), Google Sheets, WhatsApp Catalogue, Meta's free business agent (could cover enquiry replies), WhatsApp inbox vendors (S5). **Limits:** none of this evidences small-seller pain or willingness to pay; market-size figures I found were inconsistent and unused (S7). Competitor pricing was not retrievable and is unverified.

D. Offer and pricing

Package: ₹999 one-time, 60 days. **Buyer:** the seller-owner; **trigger:** a big festive/wedding inquiry they are afraid to mis-quote. **Includes:** setup of up to 40 of their items/prices (done by me), unlimited quotes in the tool, validation checks, shareable summary. **Excludes:** WhatsApp sending, payments, AI chat parsing, inventory, GST filing. **Why ₹999:** low enough for an impulse UPI payment, high enough to separate real intent from "looks nice". It is a **hypothesis**: at 5 customers it earns ₹4,995 and does not recover the ₹10,000 budget; it only tests demand.

E. Smallest useful product

One journey: inquiry form → validation → editable quote → customer summary (built as a local prototype with mock data; 9 logic + 5 UI checks pass). Rules-based pricing from the seller's price list; **no AI in the quote engine** (a wrong AI price costs real money). Manual: price-list setup, onboarding, support. Simulated in prototype: AI parsing, WhatsApp, payments, saving.

F. Journey and first five paying customers

Discovery (Instagram reel/carousel; community post) → landing page with sample quote → lead capture (WhatsApp/Google Form: name, handle, orders per month) → 15-minute demo call → UPI payment link → I load their price list within 24h → they quote real inquiries → feedback call day 14 → renewal/referral ask before wedding season.

Funnel arithmetic (all rates are assumptions): 5 paid ÷ 30% demo-to-paid = 17 demos; 17 ÷ 50% qualified-to-demo = 34 qualified sellers; 34 ÷ 12% contacted-to-qualified ≈ 283 sellers contacted ≈ 95/week over 3 weeks ≈ 14/day. **Risk:** that volume is heavy for one person; if reply rates are half, expect 2–3 customers. Fallback channel: partner with admins of seller communities (asset B). Detail: first_five_customers.md.

G. Budget and execution (hypothetical ₹10,000; **actual spent: ₹0**)

Domain/hosting ₹1,200 · reel/props and sample-hamper photos ₹1,500 · community giveaway/partnership ₹2,500 · small test boost ₹3,000 (only after organic signal; not run here) · contingency ₹1,800. Free tools first: Google Forms/Sheets, WhatsApp Business, UPI/payment links. **Five dev-days:** D1 price-list import + save; D2 quote PDF; D3 WhatsApp-ready share + landing page; D4 payments link + analytics events; D5 fixes, onboarding doc.

H. 30-day validation

Primary metric: paid conversions at ₹999. **Guardrails:** demo no-show <40%; refund requests 0; setup time ≤45 min/seller. **Continue** ≥5 paid and ≥3 of them quote a real inquiry; **change** (e.g., service-led "we quote for you", different price, or pivot to tutors) if 2–4 paid or many demos but no payment; **stop** ≤1 paid after 283 contacts or if sellers say free tools are enough. See validation_plan.md.

I. Biggest risk

Strongest failure reason: sellers do not feel quoting as painful or already get "good enough" from free tools (Vyapar, WhatsApp, Meta's agent). **Riskiest assumption:** E6/E7 (pain + willingness to pay). **Cheapest first test:** 10 seller conversations plus a ₹999 pre-order landing page, before building anything beyond this prototype.